



## PART 4 STARTING POINTS: Media audiences

**How audiences are grouped and categorised by media industries, including by age, gender and social class, as well as by lifestyle and taste.**

Mainstream magazines categorise the core buyer profile of their audiences precisely to package their demographic 'data' and deliver them to advertisers to make money. As THIIIRD is independent and does not rely on advertising for profit, the audiences they are targeting are much more loosely defined, a collection of diverse niche audiences.

When asked who constitutes the audience of THIIIRD, Rhona responded:

*'What we care about is very people of colour centred, very women-led and queer, so naturally, we find people who identify in these ways are a huge part of our audience... Another is anyone who loves music, art, fashion and photography, and cares about making society better for those communities.'*<sup>20</sup>

**How media producers target, attract, reach, address and potentially construct audiences.**

THIIIRD immediately engages audiences through its striking aesthetic: a colourful and sophisticated layout and design style that showcases its subjects and content through arresting and beautifully composed photographic images of unusual, intriguing subjects. The subjects of the photographs draw your attention to a collection of interesting people, gathered together in one community. It is intriguing and educational; in that you can find out about other cultures and their heritage as well as identify with aspects of your own. THIIIRD addresses and constructs their audience as a community of like-minded people, interested in art, culture, fashion and heritage and who want to bring about social change to enhance equality.

The language of the About Us page is direct, confident and assertive, conveying a clear sense of vision of what the magazine stands for. Elsewhere, the mode of address is friendly, informal and uses the colloquial language of its community, making the reader feel part of the group, with images of the editorial team to emphasise that connection.

On Instagram, there is a short clip of the production team sitting around a table, and the camera cuts between them giving the impression that we are a part of the circle, joining in the conversation.

**How media industries target audiences through the content and appeal of a media products and through the ways in which they are marketed, distributed and circulated.**

Part of its appeal is there isn't anything else like it. It is true that THIIIRD was inspired by gal-dem magazine, and the refreshing way gal-dem spoke to its young Black female audience, but THIIIRD engages a much wider group of readers from all different backgrounds and heritages.

*'Traditional outlets may have woken up to the demand there is to champion new styles of beauty, but they are still heavily packaged, because they still on some level are about pleasing dominant western standards.'*<sup>21</sup>

**How audiences interact with the media and can be actively involved in media production.**

The website facilitates interaction and positively encourages readers to participate. There are straightforward options buttons to Contact us, either to say hi, ask a question or to suggest an idea. There is another button to send ideas for submissions, and that gives more clear, formal information about how to format your pitch for your idea.

<sup>20</sup> <https://www.upmpaper.com>

<sup>21</sup> Rhona Ezuma interview  
<https://magculture.com/blogs/journal/rhona-thiird>